

Word family: **awake / awoke / awoken / awaken / awakening / wake / wakeful**

Base word: awake

Past tense: awoke

Past participle: awoken

Related forms: awaken, awakening, wake, wakeful

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / verb (動詞 , 較正式或文學用法) / related verb and noun forms (相關動詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “Even after a short chat, I often walk away feeling lighter and more **awake**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **awake** is figurative.

It does **not** simply mean “not sleeping.” It means **mentally alert, refreshed, aware, and more engaged with what is happening around you**.

The speaker means that after talking to Mr. Wong, he feels mentally clearer and more alive to ideas and surroundings.

繁體中文： **頭腦變得更清醒、警覺和有精神，對周圍事物及想法更有意識、更投入**

中文翻譯：

> “I often walk away feeling lighter and more **awake**.”

「我往往也會覺得心情更輕鬆、頭腦更**清醒 / 更有精神**。」

Here:

awake = 精神和思維處於清醒、警覺、有活力的狀態

1. **awake = not sleeping (人 / 動物) — 醒着的 ; 沒有睡着的**

This is the basic literal meaning.

Meaning: Conscious and not asleep.

Practice 1

> “I was still **awake** at midnight.”

「午夜時我仍然**醒着 / 沒有睡着**。」

Practice 2

> “The baby is finally **awake**.”

「寶寶終於**醒了**。」

awake = 處於清醒狀態，沒有睡着

This is the ordinary sleep-state meaning.

2. **awake = mentally alert / aware (精神 / 思維) — 清醒的；警覺的；有精神的**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: Mentally alert, attentive, and conscious of what is happening, rather than tired, dull, or mentally passive.

Practice 3 — Original

> “I often walk away feeling lighter and more **awake**.”

「我往往也會覺得心情更輕鬆、頭腦更**清醒 / 更有精神**。」

Practice 4

> “A short walk outside made me feel more **awake**.”

「出去走一會兒令我覺得更**清醒、更有精神**。」

Practice 5

> “The discussion left the students more **awake** to the issue.”

「那場討論令學生對這個議題變得更**有意識 / 更警覺**。」

awake = 精神上較清醒、注意力較集中，對周圍事情或思想更有意識

This is related to literal wakefulness, but figuratively extended to mental engagement.

3. **awake to + fact/risk/possibility (事實 / 風險 / 可能性) — 意識到 ; 警覺到**

This is a more formal use.

Meaning: Aware of or alert to a fact, danger, possibility, problem, etc.

Practice 6

> “We need to be **awake to** the risks.”

「我們需要對這些風險保持**警覺 / 有所意識**。」

Practice 7

> “She became increasingly **awake to** the problems in the system.”

「她愈來愈**察覺到**系統中的問題。」

be awake to something = 對某項事實、風險或可能性保持清楚意識和警覺

For core counting, I would treat this as closely related to Meaning 2, but it is useful enough to show because the grammar and Chinese gloss are distinct.

4. **awake = become conscious after sleep (動詞) — 醒來**

As a verb, **awake** can mean to stop sleeping and become conscious.

This use is more formal or literary than **wake up**.

Practice 8

> “She **awoke** before sunrise.”

「她在日出前**醒來**。」

Practice 9

> “He **awoke** to the sound of rain.”

「他被雨聲**弄醒 / 醒來時聽到雨聲**。」

awake = 由睡眠狀態轉為清醒

Modern everyday English usually prefers:

> **wake up**

rather than:

> **awake**

as the main verb.

5. **awake = arouse a feeling/awareness (動詞 , 較文學) — 喚起 ; 激起**

A more figurative verb use means causing a feeling, memory, interest, or awareness to arise.

Practice 10

> “The story **awoke** memories of his childhood.”

「這個故事**喚起了**他童年的回憶。」

Practice 11

> “The experience **awoke** a new interest in history.”

「這次經歷**激起了**他對歷史的新興趣。」

****awake something = 使某種感情、回憶、興趣或意識開始出現****

This use is valid but more literary/formal than ordinary ****awaken**** or ****arouse****.

Related form: ****awaken****

****Awaken**** can mean either literal waking from sleep or figurative arousing of awareness/feeling.

Practice 12

> “She ****awakened**** suddenly in the night.”

「她半夜突然****醒來****。」

Practice 13

> “The documentary ****awakened**** public interest in the issue.”

「這部紀錄片**喚起了**公眾對這個議題的興趣。」

****awaken = 使人從睡眠中醒來，或使某種感情、興趣、認知開始出現****

Related form: ****awakening****

****Awakening**** can mean the act of waking or, more commonly in figurative use, a new awareness or realization.

Practice 14

> “The trip was a cultural ****awakening**** for him.”

「這次旅程令他有了一次文化上的****覺醒 / 新認識****。」

Practice 15

> “The book contributed to a political ****awakening**** among young readers.”

「這本書促成了一些年輕讀者的政治****覺醒 / 意識提升****。」

****awakening = 對某個思想、問題、文化或現實突然產生新的意識和理解****

This is a useful lexical extension.

Related form: ****wakeful****

****Wakeful**** means unable to sleep or remaining awake and alert.

Practice 16

> “He spent a ****wakeful**** night worrying about the interview.”

「他因擔心面試而過了一個****難以入睡的晚上****。」

Practice 17

> “She remained ****wakeful**** despite the late hour.”

「雖然時間很晚，她仍然保持****清醒****。」

****wakeful = 沒有睡着、難以入睡，或持續保持清醒的****

Important distinction: ****awake vs asleep****

These are direct opposites.

**awake**

= not sleeping

**asleep**

= sleeping

> “The child is awake.”

「孩子醒着。」

> “The child is asleep.”

「孩子睡着了。」

Important distinction: ****awake vs wake****

**awake**

is commonly an adjective:

> “I’m awake.”

**wake**

is commonly a verb:

> “I woke up at seven.”

In modern everyday English, ****wake up**** is much more common than verbal ****awake****.

Important distinction: ****awake vs alert****

awake

can simply mean not sleeping.

alert

means mentally attentive and ready to notice or respond.

A person can technically be:

> awake but not very alert

for example, just after waking up.

In your passage, however, **awake** is closer to **mentally alert and refreshed** than simply “not asleep.”

Important distinction: **awake vs aware**

awake

focuses on wakefulness or mental alertness.

aware

means having knowledge or consciousness of a particular fact or situation.

> “I’m awake.”

= 我醒着。

> “I’m aware of the problem.”

= 我知道 / 意識到這個問題。

But in:

> “awake to the danger”

the meanings overlap strongly.

Important distinction: **awake vs alive**

These are sometimes confused because both can be translated figuratively as “有精神 / 有活力”.

awake

focuses on consciousness, alertness, mental clarity.

alive

focuses on being living, energetic, vivid, or full of life.

In your passage:

> **more awake**

= 頭腦更清醒、更警覺

not:

> more alive biologically

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **awake**

* **awoke**

* **awoken**

* **awaken**

* **awakening**

* **wake**

* **wakeful**

The most useful semantic contrasts are:

* **awake = not sleeping**

* **awake = mentally alert**

* **awake to something = aware of it**

* **awake/awaken = become conscious or arouse awareness**

* **awakening = new awareness or realization**

The Golden Manual says related forms should be included when they add real learning value, especially when they carry distinct meanings or usage patterns.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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awake — not sleeping	人或動物處於清醒狀態，沒有睡着
awake — mentally alert	頭腦清醒、有精神、注意力集中，對周圍事情較有意識
awake to something	對某項事實、風險、問題或可能性保持清楚意識和警覺
awake — verb, wake from sleep	由睡眠狀態轉為清醒；較正式或文學化
awake — verb, arouse feeling/awareness	使某種感情、回憶、興趣或意識開始出現；較文學化
awaken	使人醒來，或喚起某種感情、興趣或認知
awakening	對某個思想、問題、文化或現實產生新的意識和理解
wakeful	沒有睡着、難以入睡或持續保持清醒的

For your original sentence

> “I often walk away feeling lighter and more ****awake****.”

The exact meaning is:

****awake = 精神更清醒、警覺、有活力，對想法和周圍事物更有意識****

So:

> ****feeling more awake****

= ****覺得頭腦更清醒、更有精神、更能留意和思考周圍的事情****

For your database, I would count ****4 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****awake****:

1. ****not sleeping****
2. ****mentally alert / refreshed / engaged****
3. ****awake to something — aware or alert to it****
4. ****verb — wake from sleep or arouse awareness/feeling****

I would treat ****awaken, awakening,**** and ****wakeful**** as family extensions rather than inflate the core count.